25900217 MGU- UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION, MARCH 2025
SECOND SEMESTER
MG2DSCTRS100 - INDIAN LITERATURES IN ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Part A – MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries 1 mark

1. b. Compulsory English (CO1)
2. b. They believed in honoring life and following nature's laws (CO2)
3. a. Bhima's wife (CO2)
4. a. Rabindranath Tagore (CO2)
5. c. Heer- Ranjha (CO3)
6. b. Trust is selectively given (CO3)
7. c. He vents his frustration and finds emotional release. (CO4)
8. a. To ensure that the village follows strict religious codes (CO4)
9. a. Government lies (CO4)
10. c. Unload their worries (CO4)

PART B - Short Answers
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. Through the medium of translation - English as a link language - Academic medium (CO1)

12. Kunti's ultimate sin refers to the abandonment of her firstborn Karna. Kunti followed the assumptions and values of the royal palace (rajavritta) and abandoned Karna for fear of public shame. Shedding her royal duties and living in the forest, Kunti engages in self-questioning which leads her to confession. (CO2)

13. Krishna's interference in the mace duel between Bhima and Duryodhana changed the course of Kurukshetra war. When Bhima was about to lose, Krishna signals him about Duryodhana' s thigh. Bhima strikes Duryodhana's thigh and defeats him which is against the rules of 'dharma'. This incident was significant in stripping away the glory of Kurukshetra war as a war based on dharma. (CO2)

14. The speaker of the poem "On the Death of an Adopted Son" expresses his anguish and deep sorrow on the death of his adopted son whom he loved deeply - recollects the promise made by his adopted son about meeting him again on Judgement Day - expresses his longing to meet his son - reference to the Judgement Day gives the poem a religious temper. (CO2)

15. The short story *"Khol Do"* ("Open It") by Saadat Hasan Manto - a powerful and disturbing portrayal of the psychological devastation caused by war and the horrors of Partition in 1947 - uses the tragic fate of a young girl, Sakina, and the despair of her father, Sirajuddin, to reveal how deeply war can scar the human mind and soul.
Loss of identity and humanity – Sakina, a victim of rape and severe trauma - loses touch with normal emotional or social responses. When the doctor says "Khol do" (open it), intending it as an instruction for the window, Sakina responds by instinctively loosening her shalwar cord — showing how she has been conditioned by repeated abuse – this moment captures the brutal destruction of her sense of self and autonomy.

Mental breakdown of the father - Sirajuddin's psychological torment central to the story - loses his wife in the chaos of Partition - obsessively searches for his daughter - his hope, desperation, and final joy upon seeing her move are tragically misplaced — he interprets her movement as life returning, unaware of what she has endured - inability to grasp the extent of her trauma shows the psychological denial and helplessness war inflicts on survivors.
Dehumanization of victims - soldiers who rescue Sakina are initially seen as saviours - later implied they are her abusers - war corrupts – protectors turned into predators - moral decay - reveals how war dehumanizes individuals, blurring the lines between right and wrong, protector and violator.
Symbolism of life and speech - Sakina is silent, a symbol of countless voiceless victims. When she finally responds to "Khol do," it's not a return to consciousness, but a conditioned, tragic reflex. Her silence speaks volumes about psychological trauma — sometimes so deep that it silences the soul. (CO3)

16. Chandri was a dalit woman - Thus talking to her was considered to be polluting according to the Brahmins - She was treated less than an equivalent human by them. (CO4)

17. Muthu Pattar treated many people in the village but couldn't diagnose his own ailment – frustrated and confused - what was the use of treating people for so many years. (CO4)

18. Cockfight contrasts with the peaceful and non-violent ideals of the Brahmins - signifies Praneshacharya's defiance - hypocratic nature of Brahmins. (CO4)

19. Melige festival is full of life, sound and sensuality - music, dance and mingling of various castes and communities - symbolises the larger world outside the agrahara, a world that is diverse and chaotic. (CO4)

PART C – Essay
Answer any 1 question. Each question carries 15 marks

20. Indian literature influenced by English and Western writings - Translated works from different regional languages to English made people experience and study various literatures - English emerged as link language and benefitted writers especially educated people - Our culture acquired and adopted adaptions from England and the Western world. (CO1)

21. Bhasa in "The Shattered Thigh" questions the assumptions about dharma and adharma - dramatizes the mace duel between Bhima and Duryodhana at the end of the Kurukshethra war. Krishna's interference changed the course of the Kurukshethra war. When Bhima was about to lose, Krishna signals him about Duryodhana' s thigh. Bhima strikes Duryodhana's thigh and defeats him which is against the rules of 'dharma' - this incident significant in stripping away the glory of Kurukshethra war as a war based on dharma - play questions the futility of pride and the devastating impact of war. Duryodhana presented with a tinge of tragic heroism - his characterization deviates from the conventional image of the antagonist of *The Mahabharata* - victory and defeat are relative and purely context bound - conflict arises between sense of duty and righteousness - Bhima wins against Duryodhana but cannot escape the indictment of violating the rules of war - the very idea of 'victory' in war sounds meaningless. (CO2)

22. Manto's Urdu short-story "Khol Do!" (translated in English as "Open It!") recounts a poignant event related to the traumatic experience of Partition - depicts the unbearable anguish, savagery and trauma of Partition - a powerful narrative which deals with the division of the country and its aftermath - provides a unique perspective about the atrocities committed - Manto presents violence as violence - cannot be termed as "Hindu violence against Muslims" or vice versa - articulates his opinion that it was human violence against human beings. People who suffered because of the Partition were first human beings, not communal or religious beings - killings targeted against some "other" community or race or religion - cannot be approved - animalistic nature of human beings who not only sadistically enjoy others' suffering but also partake and aggravate it. (CO3)

23. Poem 'Fungus', the protagonist lies inside the cold and dark room - lives isolated from the bright and warm outdoors - protagonist compares himself to a fungus - reflects a deep existential loneliness and alienation - fungus can be interpreted as a metaphor for psychological decay or moral corruption. (CO4)